HL7 AU Project Scope Statement

HL7 Australia Terminology (THO-AU) 1.0

This Project Scope Statement form is to be completed for all new releases of standards or other products, or for reaffirmation, re-circulation or withdrawal ballots.

An approved Project Proposal is needed to proceed with any Project Scope Statement approval. This may be a previously approved Project Proposal, or a new Project Proposal approval request may be submitted at the same time as a Project Scope Statement for the initial release of a published standard or other product.

The correct completion of the submitted form will ensure that the HL7 AU Technical Steering Committee is presented with all the required information to support their consideration and approval process in a timely manner. The content will provide transparency to stakeholders on the project, expectations, direction and timeframes which in turn will support consensus-based standards development.

Please submit completed forms to projects@hl7.au

Project Scope Statement

Project Title	HL7 Australia Terminology (THO-AU) 1.0.0
Project Description	The project intends to develop a new HL7 Australia publication consisting of a mix of normative and informative content that will include technical artefacts, processes for content management, profiles of FHIR terminology resource types, and guidance documentation. The intent is to make THO-AU (and its corresponding FHIR Package) a valuable building block for other HL7 Australia FHIR IGs such that they have the option to have their terminology content managed separately under a shared ownership model that can be aligned with other Work Groups' needs.
Project Need	HL7 AU Work Groups have challenges in authoring and maintaining the terminology resources used in their implementation guides. The Terminology Work Group consulted the FHIR, eRequesting and AU Core Work Groups during July and August 2026, which identified the following: • **Terminology changes are bound to the release of the implementation guide that carries it.** Content needed by one Work Group forces coordinated releases and rework across others, and corrections wait on the carrying guide's next release. • **There is no agreed basis for deciding where terminology belongs, or how or when it should move.** Content has been placed in shared implementation guides, with a tension between serving a specific use case and being generic enough to share. Some Australian content has no current home or governance at all. • **Terminology resources are shared — if not in ownership, then in the impact of change — and we need a way of tracking that sharing.** Implementation guides that only bind to, or strengthen bindings on, content owned elsewhere are still exposed when it changes, and the impact may be breaking. Existing mechanisms record a single owning Work Group, which does not fit an Australian structure where shared content sits in AU Base, and does not identify the projects a change would affect. Changes could reach Work Groups without notice. • **Code systems are designed without sight of all their uses.** Codes defined for one use case are bound in others where they do not make sense, and no single Work Group holds all the perspectives needed to judge this. • **Australian organisations authoring or using terminology have no guidance to work to.** Externally defined terminology resources such as test and procedure lists are exchanged as spreadsheets with inconsistent code properties, and there is no settled Australian guidance on authoring and governance of these resources. Once available, THO-AU will allow HL7 Australia terminology content to be:

	• re-used, • managed separately, but under a shared ownership model determined through consultation with the work groups who create or rely upon the content, • consistent in their authoring and maintenance, • changed with the knowledge, and where required the approval, of the Work Groups and projects that depend on it, • supported by guidance that HL7 Australia Work Groups and other Australian terminology authors can apply, and • more easily and consistently adapted to new versions of FHIR, as required. •
Project Scope	○ Product Family – FHIR ○ Product ▪ Implementation Guide ○ Intent for this artifact ▪ The Terminology Work Group intends for this IG to serve as a foundation IG for other IGs, similar to AU Base, providing shared terminology resources, technical governance structures and processes for those resources, and general guidance for other maintainers of terminology content in Australia. ○ Intended Release Type ▪ Working Standard ○ Target Release Timeline: First ballot cycle in 2027. ○ **In scope** ▪ Previously balloted content from AU-Base, and/or new content where the responsible work groups for that content are in favour of inclusion of the content in THO-AU ▪ Profiles for HL7 Australia terminology resources, covering CodeSystem and ValueSet. ▪ A published process for updates to HL7 Australia terminology resources, including the transition of resources into the implementation guide from other implementation guides. ▪ A mechanism for tracking the stakeholder groups in a terminology resource, and processes for ensuring proper consultation as part of change processes. ▪ General, high-level authoring and governance guidance for Australian organisations that author or manage terminology resources. ○ **Out of scope** ▪ Transfer of any artefact without the agreement of the Work Group responsible for it. The project does not assume ownership of content from other Work Groups or implementation guides. ▪ Any requirement that an HL7 Australia implementation guide depend on or contribute content to THO-AU. ▪ A release cadence for THO-AU independent of its dependent implementation guides. This depends on HL7 Australia balloting

<table>
<tr><td></td><td colspan="6">arrangements that still to be determined, and may be considered for a subsequent release.
▪ Profiles for other terminology resources. Resources such as ConceptMap and NamingSystem were not raised in consultation with other Work Groups, but could be considered in a future release.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Product Info</td><td>Product Family</td><td>Product</td><td>Intent</td><td>Lineage</td><td>Release Type</td><td>Target Release</td></tr>
<tr><td>FHIR</td><td>Implementation Guide</td><td>Other (New and transferred content)</td><td>N/A</td><td>Working Standard</td><td>First ballot cycle of 2027.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Primary Work Group</td><td colspan="6">Terminology Work Group</td></tr>
<tr><td>Co-sponsoring Work Group(s)</td><td colspan="6"></td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="6">Project Team</td><td colspan="2">Project Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Terminology Work Group Co-Chairs
• Aimee Solomon (Primary)
• Jim Steel
• Reuben Daniels</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">FHIR IG Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Terminology Work Group Co-Chairs
• Aimee Solomon
• Jim Steel (Primary)
• Reuben Daniels</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">Publishing Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">• Brett Esler</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">Vocabulary Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Terminology Work Group Co-Chairs
• Aimee Solomon
• Jim Steel
• Reuben Daniels</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">Modelling Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">N/A</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="6"></td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="3">Supporting Organisations</td><td colspan="2">Australian Digital Health Agency</td><td colspan="3">Aimee Solomon</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">CSIRO</td><td colspan="3">Jim Steel</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">Saludax</td><td colspan="3">Reuben Daniels</td></tr>
<tr><td>Other Interested Parties</td><td colspan="6">FHIR Work Group</td></tr>
<tr><td>Developing Organisation(s)</td><td colspan="6">Australian Digital Health Agency
CSIRO
Saludax</td></tr>
<tr><td>FHIR Accelerator(s)</td><td colspan="6">N/A</td></tr>
<tr><td>External Drivers</td><td colspan="6">N/A</td></tr>
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Dependencies	• FHIR Release 4 (R4) • HL7 Terminology (THO) • AU Base (project dependency) • External Code systems currently referenced in AU Base ValueSet definitions
Related Projects	• AU Base • Others TBD
HL7 AU Managed Project Repository URL	TBD
Compatibility	Backwards Compatibility: N/A AU Base / AU Core Variance: N/A
External Code Systems	Yes. Such as external code systems currently referenced in AU Base value set definitions (https://build.fhir.org/ig/hl7au/au-fhir-base/terminology.html#code-systems)
Joint Copyright	No
External Project Collaboration	N/A
Stakeholders	All HL7 Australia Work Groups All adopters of HL7 Australia FHIR Implementation Guides Parties interested in adopting the content in the FHIR IG.
>50% External Content -	No
Developers of External Content	N/A
Realm	AU